

UNIT 4 / Build your sentences

I need a ticket

Your goal: Recognise the masculine accusative article in everyday requests.

01 Learn the idea

Some verbs connect a subject with a direct object: Ich brauche einen Stift. Ich is the subject; the pen is the thing needed. In the accusative, masculine der becomes den and ein becomes einen. Feminine die/eine and neuter das/ein stay the same in these simple patterns.

Use brauchen, kaufen and haben to practise: einen Stift, eine Tasche, ein Buch. Do not change every article to einen; first identify the noun's gender. Compare Der Stift ist blau with Ich brauche den Stift: the noun stays masculine, but its job in the sentence changes the article.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich brauche einen Stift.	I need a pen.
Ich kaufe eine Tasche.	I am buying a bag.
Ich habe ein Ticket.	I have a ticket.
Ich sehe den Bus.	I see the bus.
Brauchst du das Buch?	Do you need the book?

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Was brauchst du?

What do you need?

Ben

Ich brauche einen Stift und ein Buch.

I need a pen and a book.

Mia

Hier ist ein Stift.

Here is a pen.

Your real-life mission

Create a shopping list with Stift, Tasche and Buch. Turn each item into a sentence beginning Ich brauche and choose the article carefully.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich brauche einen Stift.” mean?

- A. I need a pen.
- B. I am buying a bag.
- C. I have a ticket.

2. What does “Ich kaufe eine Tasche.” mean?

- A. I have a ticket.
- B. I am buying a bag.
- C. I see the bus.

3. What does “Ich habe ein Ticket.” mean?

- A. I see the bus.
- B. Do you need the book?
- C. I have a ticket.

4. Complete: Ich brauche ____ Stift.

- A. ein
- B. einen
- C. eine

5. Which two things does Ben need?

- A. A bag and a ticket
- B. A pen and a book
- C. A bus and a bag

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. A - I need a pen.

“Ich brauche einen Stift.” means “I need a pen.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. B - I am buying a bag.

“Ich kaufe eine Tasche.” means “I am buying a bag.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. C - I have a ticket.

“Ich habe ein Ticket.” means “I have a ticket.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - einen

Stift is masculine and is the direct object of brauche: einen Stift.

5. B - A pen and a book

Ben asks for einen Stift und ein Buch.

One possible mission response

Ich brauche einen Stift. Ich brauche eine Tasche. Ich brauche ein Buch.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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